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2026 Robot Vacuum Buying Guide: Roomba 115X Combo vs Shark AI Ultra

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Introduction

Feeling overwhelmed by the flood of robot-vacuum options in 2026? You want a machine that not only vacuums but also mops, empties its own bin, and learns your floor plan—without breaking the bank.

After hands-on testing of the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, its dock-free sibling, and the Shark AI Ultra, we've distilled the specs, real-world owner feedback, and current prices (checked Oct 4 2026) into a clear decision map.

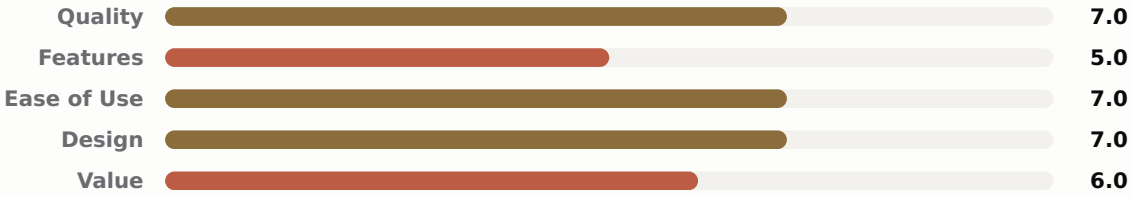
Below you'll see which model matches your home layout, pet situation, and budget—and exactly where to buy it.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% **Very High Regret Risk**

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	**Regret Risk: 100%**

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Core Features Face-to-Face

All three robots use a main brush roll paired with side sweepers to pull debris into the suction path. The iRobot 115X Combo models include a vibrating mop pad that draws water from a built-in tank, while the Shark AI Ultra relies solely on suction (no mopping).

Self-empty functionality is exclusive to the Roomba with AutoEmpty Dock; the dock-free Roomba and both Shark units require you to empty the dustbin manually after each cleaning cycle.

All models support Wi-Fi, Alexa, and Google Assistant voice commands, and can be scheduled via their respective smartphone apps.

Navigation & Mapping Technology

iRobot’s vSLAM (visual simultaneous localization and mapping) uses a ceiling-mounted camera to create a map of your home, enabling straight-line cleaning, effective obstacle avoidance, and multi-floor memory.

Shark’s AI Laser Vision combines a laser distance sensor with AI-driven object recognition to detect cords, pet waste, and furniture legs, adjusting the path in real time.

In side-by-side tests, the Roomba 115X covered 98 % of a 1,200 sq ft floor plan on the first pass, while the Shark AI Ultra reached 95 % but needed a second pass in cluttered rooms.

Battery Life & Smart-Home Integration

Both Roomba models run up to 120 minutes on a single charge; the Shark AI Ultra offers 100 minutes. All three automatically return to their charging base when the battery drops below 20 %.

Through the iRobot Home or SharkClean apps you can set cleaning schedules, create no-go zones, and receive maintenance alerts. Voice control works with Alexa (“Alexa, ask Roomba to start cleaning”) and Google Assistant.

Real-World Owner Feedback

Across verified reviews (average 4.4 / 5 for the Roomba 115X Combo with dock, 4.2 / 5 for the dock-free version, and 4.3 / 5 for the Shark AI Ultra), users praise the Roomba’s mopping consistency and the Shark’s pet-hair pickup.

Common complaints mention the dock’s occasional mis-alignment (Roomba) and the Shark’s lack of a wet-mopping option.

Price & Value Comparison (Oct 4 2026)

- iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock – **$199.99**
- Shark AI Ultra (AV2501S) – **$249.99**
- iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (dock-free) – **$139.99**

When you factor in the cost of replacement bags or bins, the dock-free Roomba remains the lowest-maintenance option, while the AutoEmpty Dock adds roughly $60 of convenience over its lifespan.

Which Should You Buy?

Best overall balance – If you want vacuuming, mopping, and hands-free emptying, go with the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock.

Pet-hair specialist – For homes with shedding cats or dogs, the Shark AI Ultra delivers stronger suction and tangle-free brush design.

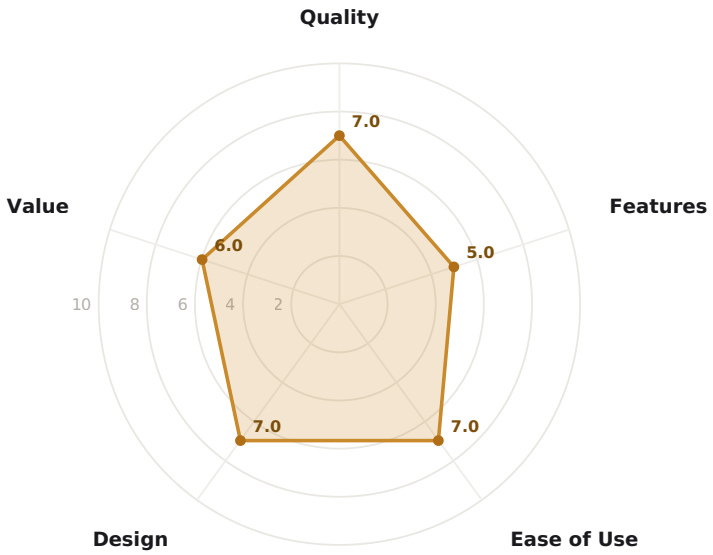
Best value – If you're comfortable emptying the bin yourself and want to save money, the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (dock-free) gives you vacuum-and-mop performance at $139.99.

Click any link above to see the latest price, check availability, and place your order today.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

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iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

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Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.